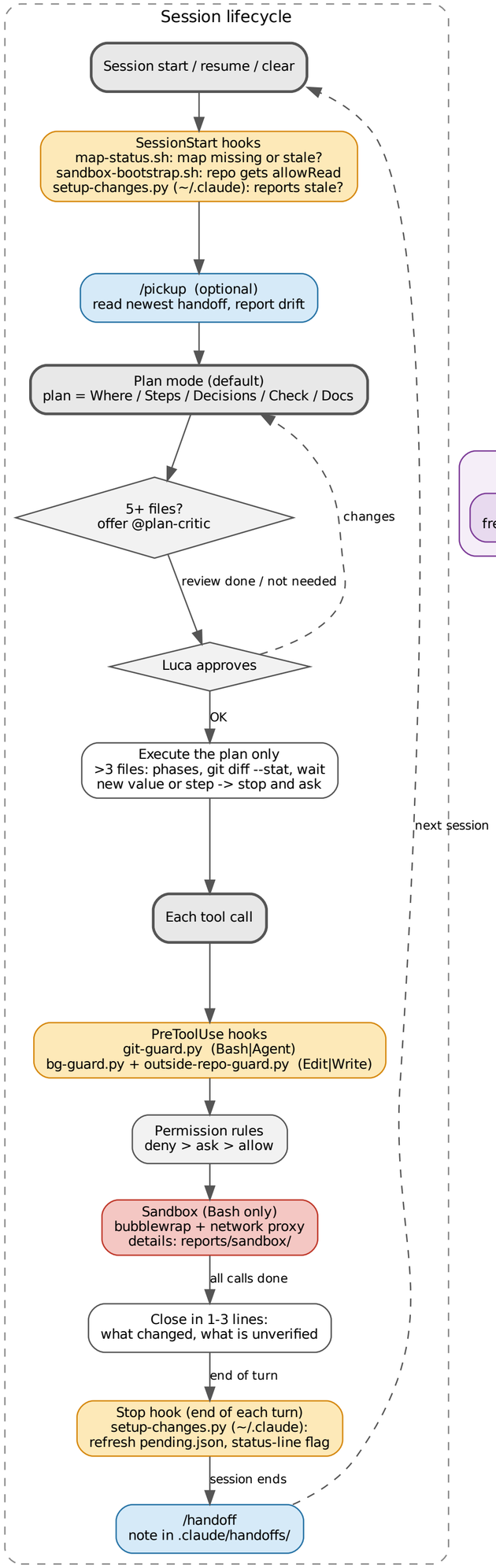
Claude Code setup at a glance (~/.claude @ a6f9d83 + uncommitted, 2026-10-30)

Session lifecycle



CLAUDE.md (global working rules)

- Project map — terse CLAUDE.md per repo, edits per MAP-RULES.md
- Changes — plan + OK first; phases; no git ops unless planned
- Reading — skip generated/vendored; grep, then read a window
- Commands — narrowest check; logs to scratchpad, tail/grep
- Sandbox — on a block: stop, name path, offer /add-dir > settings > unsandboxed
- Exploration — Explore agent only for 5+ files not edited
- Replies — answer first, no preamble

Skills (skills/)

- /handoff — save session note
- /pickup — resume from note
- /sync-claude-md — build/repair repo map (+ MAP-RULES.md)
- /sync-readme — README for humans
- /sync-setup-reports — update these reports
- plugin: mattpocock-skills — tdd, diagnosing-bugs, code-review, research, grilling, prototype, ...
- claude.ai synced (gitignored) — docs, docx, pdf, pptx, xlsx, morning, skill-creator, google-workspace, ...

Agents (agents/)

- plan-critic (opus) — fresh-eyes plan review
- explain (sonnet) — what does X do / where used
- report-sync (sonnet) — updates reports/ for /sync-setup-reports

Hooks (hooks/, wired in settings.json)

- map-status.sh — SessionStart: map missing/stale note
- sandbox-bootstrap.sh — SessionStart: repo allowRead in .claude/settings.local.json
- statusline.sh — model / ctx % / branch / worktree flag + reports stale flag
- git-guard.py — PreToolUse Bash|Agent: prompt on branch/worktree create/move/delete
- bg-guard.py — PreToolUse Edit|Write: bg jobs cannot edit existing files
- outside-repo-guard.py — PreToolUse Edit|Write: prompt outside repo, in .git/, in Claude config
- setup-changes.py — SessionStart|Stop in ~/.claude: writes reports/.sync/pending.json

settings.json

- model opus, effort medium; defaultMode: plan
- permissions — deny: secrets, browser/mail profiles; ask: EnterWorktree, ssh, scp, unsandboxed; allow: toolchain reads
- sandbox — fs allow/deny, allowedDomains, no escape without prompt
- env: conda + pip caches in ~/.cache; plugin: mattpocock-skills

State on disk

- plans/ — approved plans
- <repo>/.claude/handoffs/ — session notes (git-ignored)
- projects/*/memory/ — persistent memory + MEMORY.md
- reports/ — sandbox/, setup/
- backups/ — replaced files